
From a memorized line to a played position

THESE ARE TRAINING CONTINUATIONS

The eight continuations begin at selected course study positions. Stockfish 18 supplies legal, checked sample play through roughly move twenty. They are not historical games, forced variations or a promise of how your opponents will respond.

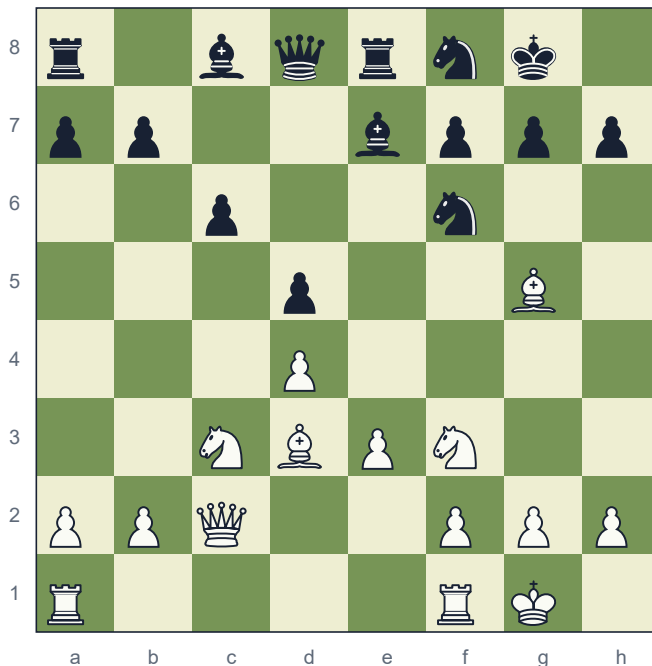
YOUR TASK BEFORE READING

Set up the move-ten position. Write the pawn structure, Black's intended break, your least active piece and two candidate moves. Spend at least five minutes before revealing the sample continuation.

DO NOT MEMORIZE THE LABORATORY

Compare the sample play with the strategic questions. If the engine chooses a move you cannot explain, inspect its concrete reply before adding it to your repertoire. Use the accompanying PGN to move through the line slowly.

Queen's Gambit Declined: the Exchange / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Complete development with a rook on b1 or c1 according to Black's setup. Prepare b4-b5, and meet a kingside initiative with exchanges or a central break.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black wants ...Ne4, piece exchanges that reduce pressure, or ...c5 before you organize a minority attack. Development can matter more than a permanent pawn weakness.

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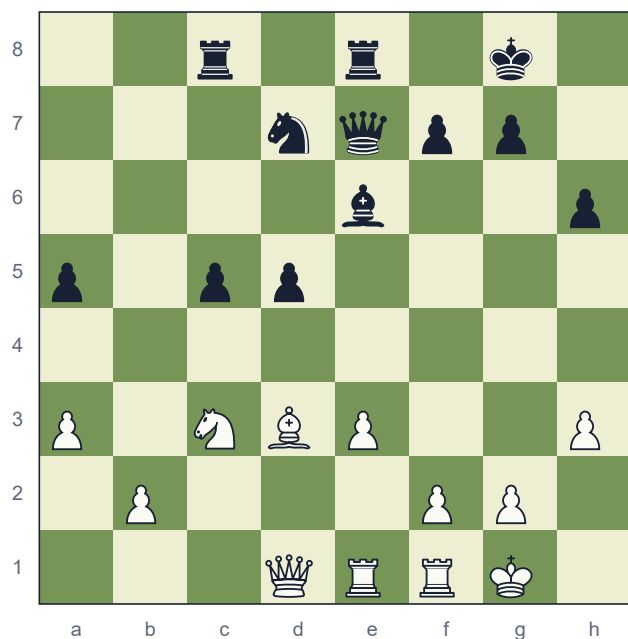
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Exchange, develop, castle, then choose the pawn break. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Queen's Gambit Declined: the Exchange / sample play

11. h3 Be6 12. a3 a5 13. Rab1 N8d7 14. Rbe1 Rc8 15. Ne5 h6 16. Bh4 c5 17. Nxd7 Nxd7 18. Bxe7 Qxe7 19. Qd1 b6 20. dxc5 bxc5



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses h3. Another searched candidate was Rae1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses Rab1. Another searched candidate was Nh2. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Ne5. Another searched candidate was Rc1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

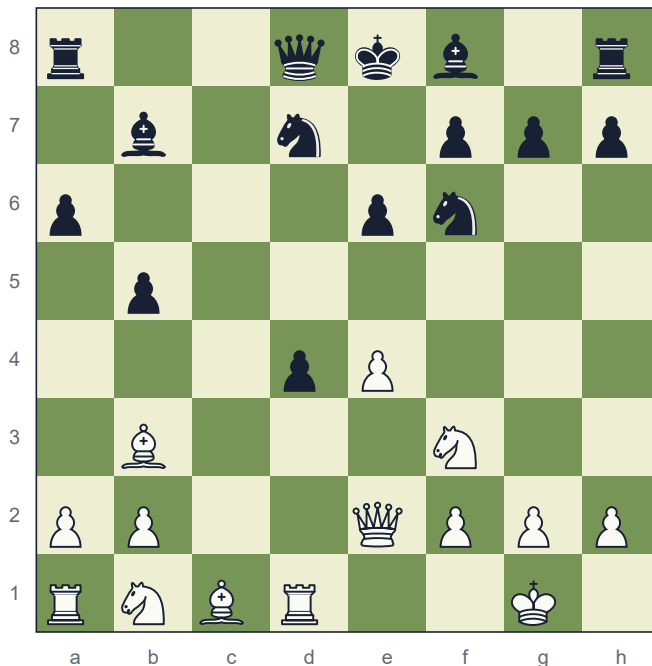
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

Queen's Gambit Accepted / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Develop the b1 knight to c3 or d2 according to tactics. Watch ...cxd4 and decide which piece or pawn should recapture.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black returns the pawn to develop freely, or tries ...b5 to hold it. The latter often gives you targets for a4 and undermining moves.

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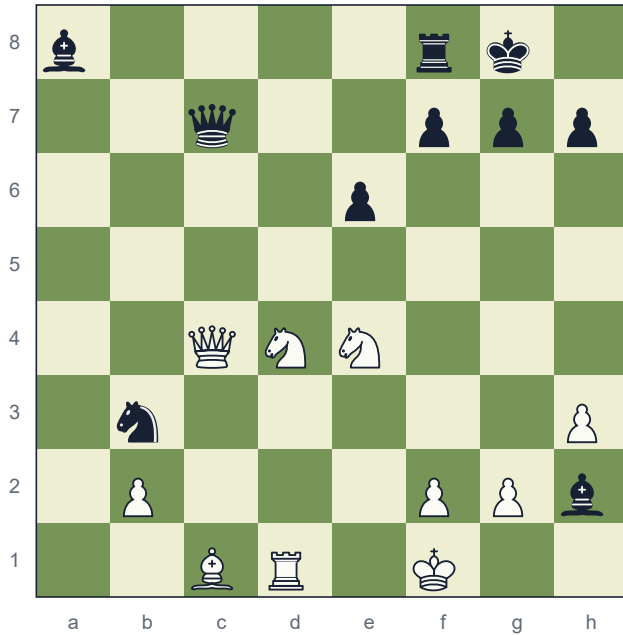
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Recover with the bishop and bring a rook to the center. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Queen's Gambit Accepted / sample play

11. Nxd4 Qb8 12. a4 Bd6 13. h3 O-O 14. axb5 axb5 15. Rxa8 Bxa8 16. Qxb5 Qc7 17. Qc4 Nc5 18. Nc3 Nfxe4 19. Nxe4 Bh2+ 20. Kf1 Nxb3



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Nxd4. Another searched candidate was a4. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses h3. Another searched candidate was g3. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Rxa8. Another searched candidate was Ra2. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

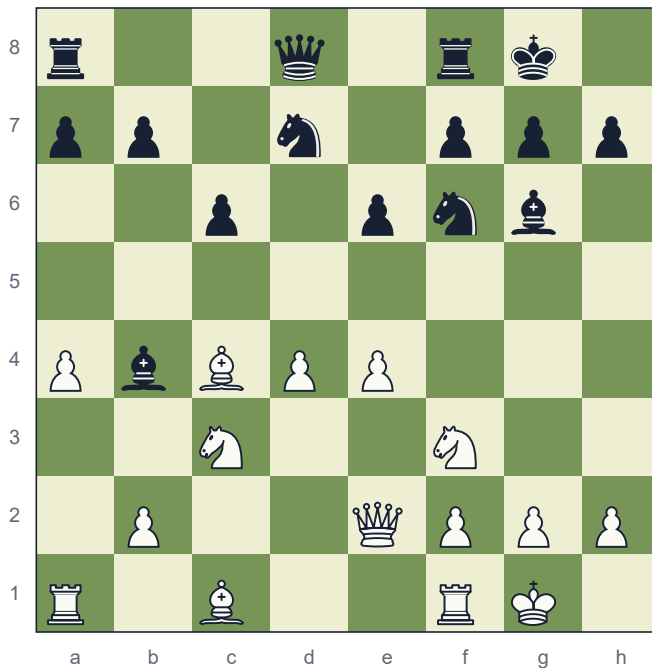
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

The Slav Defense / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Support e4, develop the c1 bishop, and watch ...Bg6 or ...Bxc3. The d4-e4 center can advance only if the pieces behind it cooperate.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black can capture c4, develop ...Bf5 or ...Bg4, play a waiting ...a6, or transpose to the Semi-Slav with ...e6.

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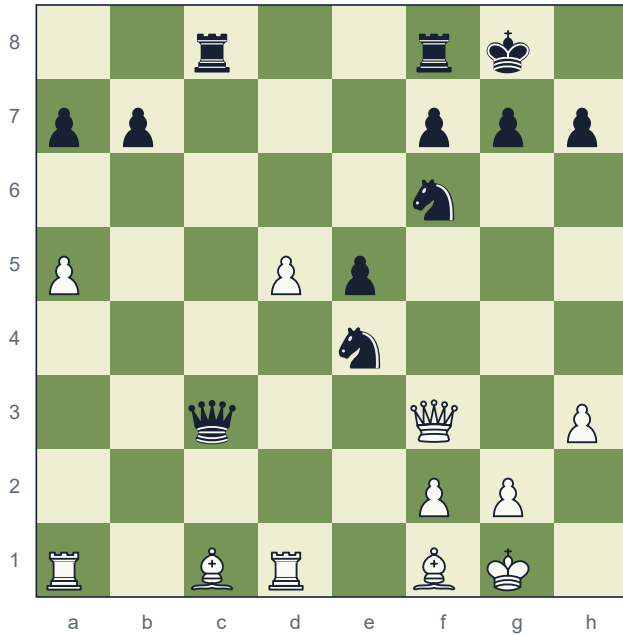
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

a4, recover c4, develop, then consider e4. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

The Slav Defense / sample play

11. Bd3 Bh5 12. h3 Bxf3 13. Qxf3 e5 14. d5 Bxc3 15. bxc3 cxd5 16. exd5 Nc5 17. Bc4 Qc7 18. a5 Rac8 19. Rd1 Nce4 20. Bf1 Qxc3



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Bd3. Another searched candidate was e5. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses Qxf3. Another searched candidate was gxf3. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses bxc3. Another searched candidate was dxc6. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

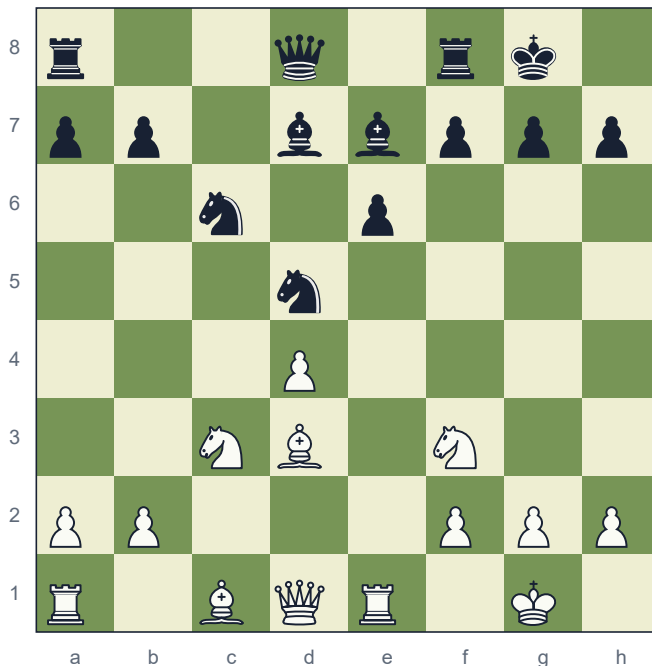
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

Tarrasch and Semi-Tarrasch / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Develop Bf4 or Bg5 when useful, bring the queen toward the center, and look for d5 when Black's pieces are uncoordinated.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black seeks rapid development and active central pieces. ...d4 or ...d5 can liquidate a weakness if the timing is right.

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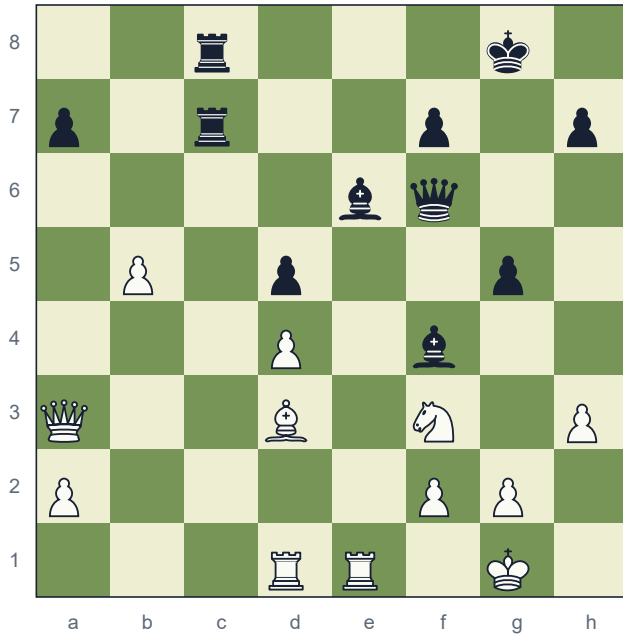
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

With the isolated pawn, play actively. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Tarrasch and Semi-Tarrasch / sample play

11. h3 Rc8 12. Nxd5 exd5 13. Qb3 Be6 14. Qxb7 Nb4 15. Bg5 Bxg5 16. Qxb4 Bf4 17. Qa3 Rc7 18. b4 Qf6 19. b5 Rfc8 20. Rad1 g5



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses h3. Another searched candidate was Nxd5. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses Qb3. Another searched candidate was Bd2. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Bg5. Another searched candidate was Bb1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

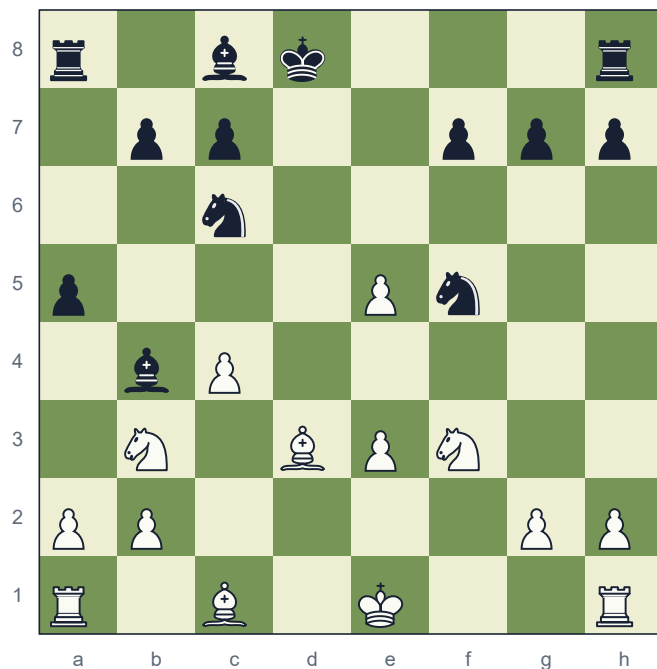
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

Albin Countergambit: a complete practical answer / start



After the opening study line - White to move - in check

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Develop the bishops, bring the king to a safe useful square, and use the extra material without rushing. Your e-pawns are doubled, so assess activity as well as pawn count.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black wants ...Bg4 or ...Be6, quick development, and sometimes queenside castling. The wedge can advance or capture on e3; it must never disappear from your threat scan.

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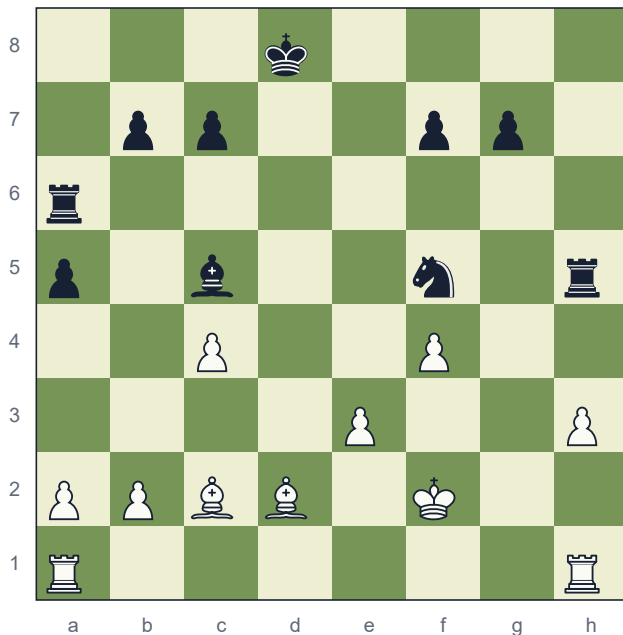
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Nb3, e4, and understand the queen trade. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Albin Countergambit: a complete practical answer / sample play

11. Kf2 Nh6 12. h3 Re8 13. Be4 Bd7 14. Nbd4 Ra6 15. Nxc6+ Bxc6 16. Bxh7 Bc5 17. Bc2 Bxf3 18. gxf3 Rxe5 19. f4 Rh5 20. Bd2 Nf5



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Kf2. Another searched candidate was Ke2. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses Be4. Another searched candidate was Rd1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Nxc6+. Another searched candidate was Rd1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

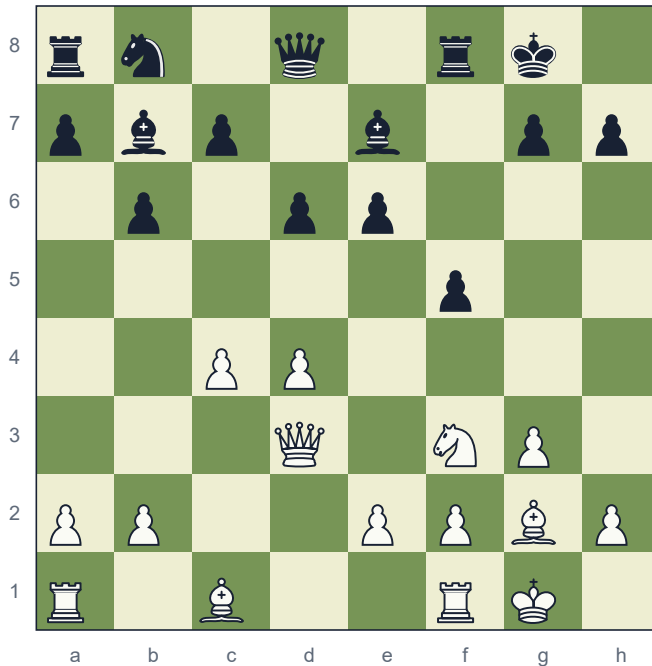
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

Queen's Indian: the g3 repertoire / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Develop the c1 bishop to f4 or g5 when appropriate. Prepare e4 or d5 only after checking the long diagonal.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

...Ba6 attacks c4; ...Bb7 pressures e4. Black may choose ...d5, ...c5 or a hedgehog-like setup with ...d6.

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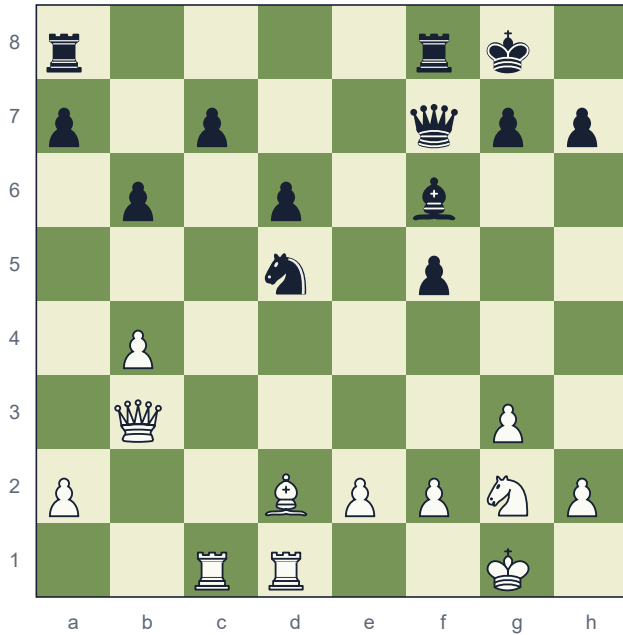
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Coordinate the center before opening the long diagonal. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Queen's Indian: the g3 repertoire / sample play

11. Qe3 Qc8 12. Bd2 Bf6 13. b4 Be4 14. Rfd1 Qe8 15. Rac1 Nc6 16. d5 exd5 17. cxd5 Ne7 18. Ne1 Nxd5 19. Qb3 Bxg2 20. Nxg2 Qf7



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Qe3. Another searched candidate was Ne1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses b4. Another searched candidate was Rac1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Rac1. Another searched candidate was a4. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

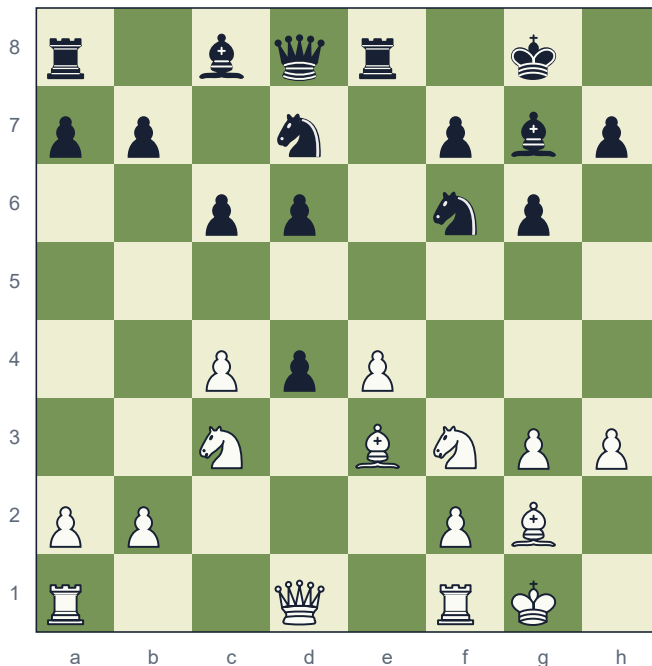
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

King's Indian: a fianchetto repertoire / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Choose Qc2, Re1 or d5 according to Black's regrouping. If the center closes, identify useful knight routes rather than launching pawns immediately.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black seeks ...e5, ...c5, and sometimes a queenside ...a6/...b5 expansion. ...f5 becomes relevant only when the knight and pawn structure permit it.

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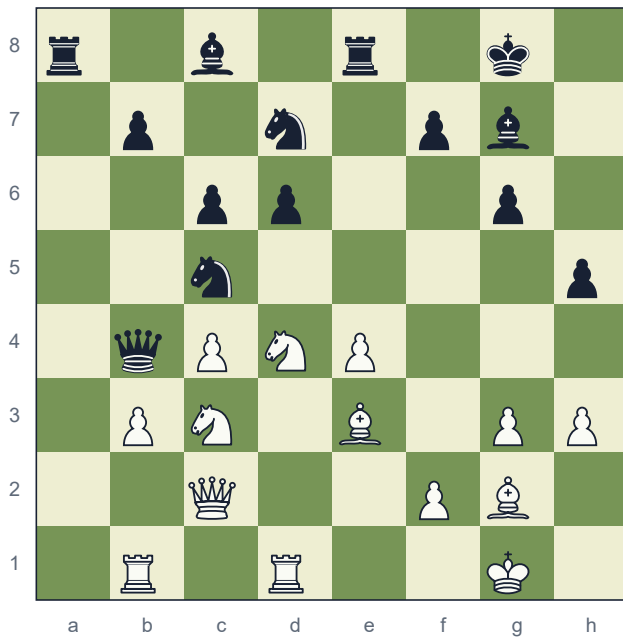
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Build the center behind a secure king. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

King's Indian: a fianchetto repertoire / sample play

11. Nxd4 a5 12. Qc2 a4 13. Rad1 Qa5 14. b3 Nc5 15. Rd2 Qb4 16. Rb1 Nfd7 17. Rdd1 h5 18. Bd2 Qb6 19. Be3 axb3 20. axb3 Qb4



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Nxd4. Another searched candidate was Bxd4. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses Rad1. Another searched candidate was Rfe1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses Rd2. Another searched candidate was Rb1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

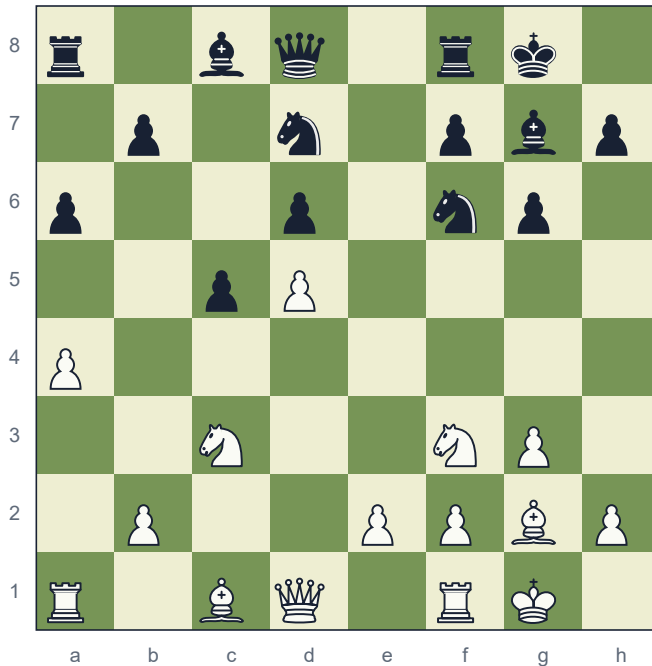
EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

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REPLAY DRILL

Play the position from move ten against a partner or engine, then switch colors. Annotate the first decision where your plan and the sample diverge. A different sound move is not automatically a mistake.

Modern Benoni: space and the fianchetto / start



After the opening study line - White to move

YOUR OPENING PLAN

Develop the c1 bishop and prepare e4. Use rooks on central files and watch for an e5 breakthrough when it opens lines favorably.

OPPONENT'S RESOURCES

Black seeks ...b5, pressure down the e-file, and piece activity against e4 or d5. A rook on e8 and bishop on g7 can cooperate tactically.

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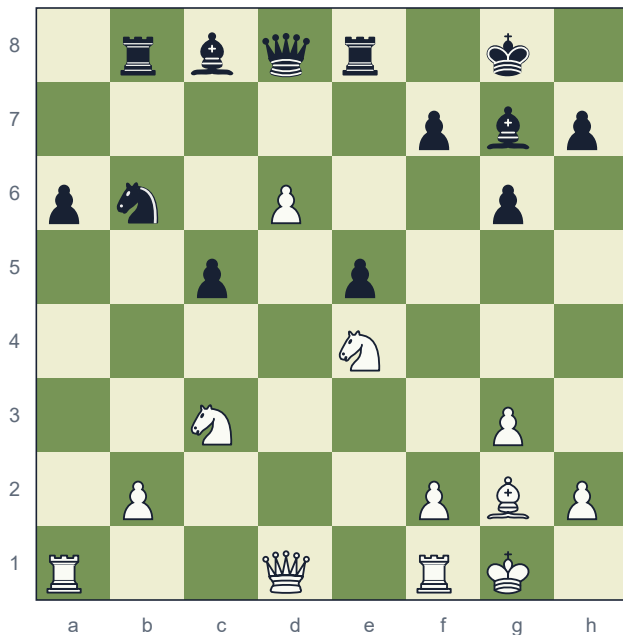
Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate Black's most forcing reply. Then write what would make you change plans: a central break, a piece exchange, or a threat against the king.

STUDY PROMPT

Keep d5, complete development, prepare e4-e5. Explain how that principle affects the current position. A move that follows the plan can still fail tactically; check it before choosing.

Modern Benoni: space and the fianchetto / sample play

11. Bf4 Qb6 12. a5 Qc7 13. e4 Re8 14. Nd2 b5 15. axb6 Nxb6 16. e5 dxe5 17. Bg5 Rb8 18. Bxf6 Bxf6 19. Nde4 Qd8 20. d6 Bg7



After sample continuation - White to move

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 11

The sample chooses Bf4. Another searched candidate was Re1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 13

The sample chooses e4. Another searched candidate was Re1. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

CANDIDATE CHECK AT MOVE 15

The sample chooses axb6. Another searched candidate was Be3. Compare their concrete replies and ask which better serves the current pawn structure.

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pawns or pieces were exchanged? Did the original plan survive, or did a central break create a new structure? Identify one position where a routine developing move would miss a concrete opportunity.

REPLAY DRILL

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